



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*dharmajñāḥ satyavādī ca tatheti pratyabhāṣata d
punaścedaṁ mahārāja papraccha prasthitaṁ gurum e
kāni rūpāṇi śakrasya bhavantyāgacchato mune d
vapustejaśca kīdrgvai tanme vyākhyātumarhasi e
bhīṣma uvāca d
tataḥ sa bhagavāṁstasmai vipulāya mahātmāne d
ācacakṣe yathātattvaṁ māyāṁ śakrasya bhārata e*

— Bhishma (Mapter 13), Verses 27-29

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The passage from the *Bhishma* is a potent exchange between King Yudhishtira and Bhishma, highlighting the nature of perception and divine manifestation. Yudhishtira, ever the seeker of truth and steeped in dharma, having received guidance from Bhishma, humbly poses a further question before Bhishma departs. He asks about the forms, the appearance, and the aura of Indra, the King of Gods, when he descends. Yudhishtira yearns to understand the tangible manifestations of divine power.

Bhishma, the wise grandsire, then unveils the truth about Indra's Maya. He explains to Yudhishtira, a great soul, the reality regarding the power and illusion of Indra. This is not merely a description of a deity's physical form; it's an exploration of how divine power manifests in the world and how our limited human perception can interpret it. Indra's 'forms' are not fixed but are rather manifestations of his divine energy tailored to the situation and the observer. The 'aura' is not merely light but the very essence of his power and influence.

This concept of Maya, as Bhishma explains, is profoundly relevant to your life. You often encounter situations and people that seem to be one thing on the surface, while their true nature is far more complex and nuanced. Like Indra's ever-changing forms, the world around you is in constant flux, and your perception of it is shaped by your own experiences, biases, and limitations. Understanding this Maya allows you to look beyond the surface appearances, to seek the deeper truth, and to avoid being misled by illusions. The passage encourages you to cultivate discernment, to question your assumptions, and to strive for a more profound understanding of the world and your place in it. By recognizing the play of Maya, you can navigate the complexities of life with greater clarity and wisdom.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you cultivate a more discerning eye to see beyond the illusions of the world and perceive the deeper truths that lie beneath the surface?